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Bill to ban 'dangerous additives' in Skittles, other foods passes California State Assembly

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Author: Marc Sternfield | Section: News | 204 Words
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(KTLA) – California is one step closer to enacting a law that would ban chemicals found in Skittles, Hot Tamales, and a host of other food items that have been linked to a number of health issues.

Assembly Bill 418, proposed by Jesse Gabriel (D-Woodland Hills), passed overwhelmingly in the California State Assembly last week and now heads to the State Senate.

The bill would prohibit the manufacture, sale, or distribution of products containing Red Dye No. 3, titanium dioxide, potassium bromate, brominated vegetable oil, or propyl paraben in the Golden State.

Those chemicals, which are already banned in the European Union, have been linked to cancer, reproductive issues, and developmental issues in children, Gabriel says.

"It's unacceptable that the U.S. is so far behind the rest of the world when it comes to banning these dangerous additives," Gabriel said in a statement. "We don't love our children any less than they do in Europe and it's not too much to ask food and beverage manufacturers to switch to the safer alternative ingredients that they already use in Europe and so many other nations around the globe."

The list of products containing these additives is vast and includes candies, medicine, pizza, drinks, coffee creamers and flour.

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